ZOUHEIR HAJJ SLEIMAN

Infrastructure & Construction Project Officer | M.E. (Structural), AUB

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Civil and Structural Engineer (M.E., AUB) with over a decade of field-based experience implementing and managing infrastructure programmes in Lebanon, funded by UNHCR, UNICEF, UNDP, the World Bank, ESFD, and CDR. Having spent more than five years as an on-the-ground implementing partner for these organisations — delivering projects, managing contractors, coordinating with donor supervision teams, and producing field and progress reports — this profile represents a practitioner seeking to contribute that implementation experience from within a UN or INGO programme team. Direct experience spans education infrastructure (rehabilitation and expansion of 21 public schools serving more than 10,000 students), healthcare construction (expansion of four governmental hospitals adding 200 beds), WASH systems (solar water pumping serving 5,000 beneficiaries), and public infrastructure across the Bekaa, North Lebanon, and Beirut governorates. Fluent in English and Arabic with working French; experienced in Lebanese field operations, community coordination, and multi-stakeholder environments.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Programme Implementation Project Lifecycle Management • Output & Outcome Monitoring • Results-Based Management • Field Supervision • Quality Assurance

Sector Experience Education Infrastructure (UNHCR/CDR) • Healthcare Construction (WASH) • Solar & Renewable Energy • Public Works & Municipal Infrastructure

Contractor Management Implementing Partner Oversight • Tendering & Procurement • BOQ Preparation & Review • Technical Submittals • Performance Monitoring

Donor Compliance UNHCR, UNDP, UNICEF, World Bank Reporting Standards • Progress & Field Visit Reports • Budget Utilisation Tracking • Donor Documentation

Stakeholder Coordination Municipality & Government Liaison • Community Engagement • Beneficiary Coordination • Inter-Agency Working Groups • Consultant Interface

Technical Oversight Structural & Civil Engineering Review • Construction Supervision • QA/QC • Site Inspections • Non-Conformance Management

Field Operations Bekaa (Baalbeck, Zahle, West Bekaa) • North Lebanon (Tripoli, Halba) • Beirut & Mount Lebanon • Challenging & Remote Site Access

Software & Tools AutoCAD • MS Office Suite (Excel, Word, PowerPoint) • Primavera P6 • AI Tools

Languages Arabic (Native) • English (Fluent) • French (Working Proficiency)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Project Manager — Infrastructure & Institutional Works *October 2016 – December 2021*

Elie Maalouf Establishment | *Bekaa, Lebanon*

- Served as on-the-ground Project Manager for a portfolio of multi-million-dollar donor-funded infrastructure programmes in Lebanon, with direct accountability for implementation quality, schedule, budget, procurement, contractor management, and donor reporting — operating as the primary implementing partner interface for UNHCR, CDR, UNDP, World Bank, and ESFD supervision teams.
- **Education infrastructure (UNHCR & CDR):** led the rehabilitation and expansion of 21 public schools across the Bekaa and North Lebanon, directly benefiting more than 10,000 students. Works included structural strengthening, WASH facility upgrades, waterproofing, accessibility improvements, and capacity expansion. Also delivered the Sariine Public School and Ersal Nursery and Workshops complex (Kuwait Funds / CDR).
- **Healthcare construction (UNHCR):** managed the COVID-19 rapid-response expansion of ICU and isolation capacity across four governmental hospitals (Baalbeck, Tripoli, Halba, Zahle), adding approximately 200 beds through fast-track structural-steel extensions and complex MEP works delivered against pandemic-driven deadlines.

- **WASH & public infrastructure (World Bank / UNDP / CDR):** supervised construction of the Qaraoun sewer network and pumping stations, Ouzai stormwater drainage lines, El-Kaa artificial irrigation lake, and the East Zahle Union of Municipalities headquarters.
- Coordinated daily with UNHCR, CDR, and UNDP donor engineers and supervision consultants during field visits; prepared and submitted progress reports, site inspection records, photographic documentation, and financial reporting packages in line with each donor's compliance requirements.
- Managed tendering and procurement of subcontractors and materials, including BOQ preparation, bid evaluation, contract award, payment certification, variation orders, claims assessment, and final account closure in line with FIDIC Red Book provisions.
- Coordinated with municipal authorities, community representatives, and school administrations throughout project implementation, managing expectations, access arrangements, and beneficiary-facing communications across multiple simultaneous sites.

Engineering Manager — Infrastructure & Construction *July 2021 – Present*
THE CUBE Construction | *Beirut, Lebanon*

- Manage concurrent infrastructure, institutional, residential, and public-sector construction projects across Lebanon, maintaining full responsibility for implementation quality, contractor coordination, scheduling, cost control, and stakeholder reporting.
- **WASH & renewable energy (UNICEF & ESFD):** led the technical assessment, design, procurement, and implementation of multiple solar water pumping systems across Bekaa municipalities (Beit Chama, Iaat, Ablah, Haouch Rafica, Chamsine), directly serving approximately 5,000 beneficiaries including host communities and refugee populations. Also supervised sewage treatment infrastructure across multiple municipalities funded by ESFD.
- Coordinate with UNICEF and ESFD donor representatives during field supervision visits; prepare technical progress reports, field inspection documentation, and handover packages in line with donor requirements.
- Supervise and coordinate more than ten engineers and forty subcontractor crews across simultaneous project sites; conduct quality inspections, manage non-conformances, and enforce HSE compliance throughout construction.
- Manage procurement and tendering processes including BOQ preparation, subcontractor bid evaluation, material submittals, and contract administration; maintain budget tracking and financial reporting across concurrent projects.

Independent Site Engineer & Field Supervisor (Part-Time) *May 2016 – July 2021*
Zouheir Hajj Sleiman Engineering Office | *Bekaa, Lebanon*

- Provided independent site supervision and technical advisory services for residential and commercial construction projects across the Bekaa region, concurrent with full-time employment.
- Coordinated with municipalities on public works projects including sewer lines, roads, and water networks; managed permitting, community liaison, and site handover processes.

Junior Civil Engineer (Part-Time, concurrent with BE studies) *January 2012 – May 2016*
Hands Group | *Beirut, Lebanon*

- Supported senior engineers in the execution and supervision of residential and commercial projects; gained foundational experience in construction supervision, site inspection, and quality compliance.

EDUCATION

Master of Engineering (M.E.) — Structural Engineering *2017*
American University of Beirut (AUB) | *Beirut, Lebanon*

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) — Civil & Environmental Engineering *2016*
Beirut Arab University (BAU) | *Beirut, Lebanon*

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- FIDIC Project Execution & Management — Order of Engineers and Architects, Beirut (Training Centre)
- Project Management • Contract Administration • Execution Management — Order of Engineers and Architects, Beirut
- Advanced Planning & Scheduling with Primavera P6 — Udemy
- AI Essentials for Business — Order of Engineers and Architects, Beirut • Google AI Professional Certificate — Coursera

- Class A Contractor Classification — Lebanese Syndicate of Public Contractors & Ministry of Public Works and Transportation

Affiliations: Order of Engineers and Architects of Beirut (OEA Beirut) • Lebanese Syndicate of Public Contractors

References: *Available upon request, including former UNHCR, UNICEF, and CDR supervision contacts.*